

Let's chat about data! A study of data discovery with Large Language Models

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STUDY PURPOSE

With the study "Let's chat about data! A study of data discovery with Large Language Models", we want to investigate how Large Language Models (LLM) can support scientific data searches. In particular, we want to investigate how scientists use LLMs to search for data and how useful they find them. Your answers will provide the basis for this research.

STUDY PROCEDURE

This study consists of a short interview, followed by two data searches, both lasting approximately 7 minutes. In both, your voice and screen will be recorded via Zoom as you perform the predefined task and describe how you do it. We use these recordings to transcribe the interview and create a model that describes your process.

After each search, you will be asked to provide a short evaluation for the tool used based on a few questions. Following the two data searches and their evaluation, we will ask you to provide some brief additional information about yourself, such as age, gender and educational background.

PROCESSING OF YOUR DATA IN THE PROJECT

Anja Perry (GESIS - Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences) is responsible for the processing of your data. Only the data collected during the study will be processed, i.e. the recordings during the task processing and your answers to the interview questions and the subsequent survey. Your contact details will not be linked to the data collected from you at any time and will be deleted once the data collection is complete.

Furthermore, employees at the German Aerospace Center and the TH Mittelhessen have access to the data collected in order to transcribe or code the data, process it and evaluate it in accordance with the purpose of the study. Your data will be treated confidentially at all times.

After transcription and coding of your data and verification of these steps, the recordings, including the recording of your screen and voice, will be deleted.

Once our analyses have been completed, the transcribed and processed data is pseudonymized. This means that the data will be changed in such a way that it will not be possible to draw any conclusions about you personally. GESIS - Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences then makes the transcribed and collected data available to other researchers in pseudonymized form.

PROCESSING YOUR DATA USING A LARGE-LANGUAGE MODEL

You will use an LLM to search for data. You will not carry out the search on your own computer, but remotely on the interviewer's computer. You do not need your own account with an LLM. Nevertheless, you will be entering information into an LLM yourself, over the processing of which we have no influence. Please therefore take care not to disclose any personal or sensitive data when working with the LLM.

YOUR RIGHTS

You have the possibility to assert the following rights at any time:

- **Art. 7, 3 GDPR:** Right to withdraw consent
You have the right to withdraw your consent at any time with effect for the future
- **Art. 15 GDPR:** Right to information
You have the right to obtain information from us about which of your personal data we process.
- **Art. 16 GDPR:** Right to rectification
If data concerning you, such as personal data, is incorrect or incomplete, you can request the correction of incorrect data or the completion of incomplete data.
- **Art. 17 GDPR:** Right to erasure
You can request the erasure of your data at any time.
- **Art. 18 GDPR:** Right to restriction of processing
You can request the restriction of the processing of your personal data.
- **Art. 21 GDPR:** Right to object
You can object to the processing of your personal data at any time.
- **Art. 77 GDPR:** Right to lodge a complaint with a supervisory authority
If you are of the opinion that we have not complied with data protection regulations when processing your data, you can lodge a complaint with the State Commissioner for Data Protection and Freedom of Information in North Rhine-Westphalia, who will examine your complaint.

In any case, your participation in our study is **voluntary** and you have the option of discontinuing the interview at any time. If you refuse or break off your participation or revoke or restrict your consent, you will **not suffer any disadvantages** as a result. There is a very low risk that the LLM used will generate disturbing, hurtful or offensive content with which you could be confronted during the study. The operators of the tools largely rule this out, but there is a very low risk that this could still happen.

At the beginning of your interview, you will be asked to confirm that you have read and understood this consent form and will have the opportunity to ask any questions you may have. We will then ask you to agree to participate in the study. **This consent will be recorded.**

CONTACT

If you have any questions or wish to exercise your rights, please contact us:

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